

High-Ranked Brawl Stars Drafting Doctrine and Algorithmic Companion Architecture

1. Draft Flow Truth Table

Competitive Brawl Stars drafting operates under a strict, non-symmetric snake draft protocol governed by sequential turn choices, complete versus partial information states, and strict Power Level 11 legality requirements. The draft sequence begins with a simultaneous blind ban phase followed by a randomized coin flip that designates Team A as the First Pick mover and Team B as the Second Pick or Last Pick mover. The pick sequence adheres strictly to the deterministic structure where Team A picks first, Team B picks twice, Team A picks twice, and Team B closes the draft: $A_1 \rightarrow B_1 \rightarrow B_2 \rightarrow A_2 \rightarrow A_3 \rightarrow B_3$.

Game-theoretic analysis reveals that draft order creates significant win-rate variance depending on meta depth, regional playstyles, and information distribution. First pick (A_1) grants first-mover advantage, enabling a team to lock an unbanned tier-zero meta anchor and force the opposing team to play reactively. Conversely, last pick (B_3) possesses complete information symmetry over all five prior selections, enabling an uncounterable hard pick that can invalidate the entire opposing composition. Regional competitive data confirms that last pick (B_3) yields statistically dominant win rates in mature competitive environments, achieving a 70% win rate in APAC and a 58% win rate in North America.

Draft Step	Active Seat	Information State (Visible Picks)	Tactical Objective	Primary Failure Mode	Game Theory Weight
Ban Phase	All Seats ($A_{\{1-3\}}$, $B_{\{1-3\}}$)	0 Picks, 0 Opponent Bans	Neutralize tier-zero meta threats or execute target bans.	Over-banning secondary picks; leaving unanswerable meta brawlers open.	High (Establishes draft boundaries)
Pick 1	A_1	0 Opponent Picks, 0 Ally Picks	Secure S-tier meta anchor or flexible anti-tank controller.	Locking a narrow assassin or glass cannon easily hard-countered by B_1 – B_2 .	High (First-Mover Advantage)
Pick 2	B_1	1 Opponent Pick (A_1), 0 Ally Picks	Soft-counter A_1 while securing a flexible midline anchor.	Over-committing to counter A_1 , exposing composition to A_2 – A_3 .	Medium-High (Pivot Setup)

Draft Step	Active Seat	Information State (Visible Picks)	Tactical Objective	Primary Failure Mode	Game Theory Weight
Pick 3	B_2	1 Opponent Pick (A_1), 1 Ally Pick (B_1)	Establish a synergistic core duo with B_1; force Team A into defense.	Exposing severe structural weakness to A_2 and A_3 counter-picks.	High (Synergy Engine)
Pick 4	A_2	2 Opponent Picks (B_{1-2}), 1 Ally Pick (A_1)	Stabilize draft structure; address lane gaps exposed by B_{1-2}.	Drafting low-damage double-support into heavy tank or wall-breaker threats.	Medium-High (Composition Core)
Pick 5	A_3	2 Opponent Picks (B_{1-2}), 2 Ally Picks (A_{1-2})	Lock primary win condition or force B_3 into sub-optimal responses.	Leaving an uncountered dive or flank vulnerability for B_3 to exploit.	High (Team A Lock)
Pick 6	B_3	3 Opponent Picks (A_{1-3}), 2 Ally Picks (B_{1-2})	Hard-counter A_{1-3} lineup; execute uncontested win condition.	Defaulting to a comfort pick that lacks hard-counter synergy.	Extreme (Information Maxima)
Ready Phase	Both Teams	6 Picks Finalized	Execute 15-second post-draft trades based on account P11 ownership.	Miscommunication; failing to swap to optimal pilot roster.	High (Pilot Optimization)

The progression of visible choices reduces optionality while increasing clarity. Team A starts with maximum optionality but zero opponent information, making A_1 vulnerable to counter-drafting if an overly specialized brawler is chosen. As the draft advances to A_2 and A_3, Team A locks its complete strategic concept, granting Team B total information clarity at B_3. High-ranked software algorithms must evaluate each selection step not merely on individual brawler win rates, but on how each pick alters information asymmetry and limits the opponent's remaining counter-picks.

2. Ban Philosophy

Ban phase decisions must strictly reflect seat position, map structural constraints, and brawler counter-density rather than personal frustration. High-ranked drafting distinguishes between eternal ban principles and seasonal meta power shifts, while differentiating casual ladder habits from competitive consensus.

Casual creators often recommend banning personal nuisance brawlers or high-frequency assassins. Conversely, competitive consensus dictates that bans serve as state-setting

mechanisms designed to shape the draft pool to favor a team's positional seat. Eternal ban doctrine dictates that bans fall into three distinct operational categories across all competitive eras:

Ban Category	Operational Definition	Strategic Objective	Target Seat Logic
Meta Power Bans	Neutralizing over-tuned tier-zero brawlers or hypercharges across modes.	Prevent catastrophic first-mover variance or unanswerable power picks.	Primarily executed by Team B when no reliable counter exists.
Map Anomaly Bans	Banning brawlers whose kits trivialize specific map architecture.	Preserve standard lane play and prevent map-breaking strategies.	Balanced across both teams based on map openness and wall placement.
Seat Denial Bans	Banning hard counters to protect a planned pick strategy.	Protect A_1 first-mover picks or preserve B_3 counter-pick viability.	Team A protects A_1 locks; Team B protects B_3 counter-picks. Team A protects A_1 locks; Team B protects B_3 counter-picks. Team A protects A_1 locks; Team B protects B_3 counter-picks.

The optimal ban logic diverges fundamentally based on whether a team holds first pick (A_1) or last pick (B_3). Team A controls the initial pick and must construct a ban state where at least one uncounterable S-tier brawler remains open. If three tier-zero brawlers exist on a given map, Team A should ban either zero or two of them. Banning zero leaves all three open, guaranteeing that Team A locks one at A_1 while Team B can only secure two at B_1–B_2. Banning two forces Team B to face the sole remaining tier-zero brawler at A_1. Banning all three tier-zero brawlers needlessly surrenders Team A's first-mover advantage. Furthermore, Team A must utilize its remaining bans to eliminate direct hard counters to its intended A_1 lock, such as banning premier anti-tanks if planning a heavy tank first pick.

Team B operates at an initial information deficit and must focus bans on limiting Team A's first-mover value. Team B must target unanswerable tier-zero brawlers that lack viable counters in the current patch. Alternatively, Team B can execute target bans designed to preserve a planned B_3 counter-pick. If Team B intends to sweep Team A with a last-pick assassin, Team B must utilize the ban phase to eliminate hard anti-dive brawlers and persistent crowd-control anchors.

3. First Pick Doctrine (A1)

The A_1 pick occurs under maximum information asymmetry, as zero opponent picks have been revealed. Selecting an easily countered or highly specialized brawler at A_1 invites Team B to execute immediate hard counters at B_1 and B_2, placing Team A at a severe structural disadvantage for the remainder of the match.

The primary requirement for an optimal A_1 selection is broad baseline stability combined with drafting flexibility. An ideal A_1 pick must satisfy multiple strategic criteria: possessing a high baseline win rate across diverse compositions, maintaining flexible role capabilities that hide Team A's macro strategy, and exhibiting strong anti-tank or anti-aggro resiliency. Midline controllers, versatile anti-tanks, and resilient lane anchors represent the premier A_1 choices because they establish zone control without committing Team A to a rigid playstyle.

Selection Category	Archetype Profiles	Primary Strategic Value	Draft Risk Profile
Optimal A1 Locks	Resilient Anti-Tanks, Versatile Midline Controllers, S-Tier Anchors.	Establishes lane control, deters aggressive tank responses, masks team strategy.	Minimal risk; forces opponent to react without offering hard-counter targets.
Prohibited A1 Locks	Short-Range Assassins, Glass Cannon Marksmen, Squishy Throwers.	High individual kill potential or burst damage in specialized scenarios.	Severe risk; easily neutralized by B_1–B_2 anti-dive or hard-counter picks.

High-ranked consensus, reinforced by pro drafting analysis, warns explicitly against locking assassins or heavy tanks at A_1 unless all anti-tank or anti-dive options have been completely banned. Securing a strong anti-tank or flexible controller at A_1 neutralizes early tank pushes from Team B and leaves A_2 and A_3 open to adapt to Team B's response.

4. Double-Pick Windows (B1–B2 and A2–A3)

Double-pick windows represent the primary tactical levers for altering composition trajectory, establishing core synergies, and setting draft traps.

The B_1–B_2 window allows Team B to respond directly to A_1 while establishing the foundational core of its team composition. The B_1 selection functions as a soft counter to A_1 or locks a highly resilient lane anchor, while B_2 pairs with B_1 to create an immediate two-brawler synergy engine. Examples of powerful B_1–B_2 combinations include pairing a heavy tank with a pocket sustainer, or pairing a long-range mid controller with an aggressive space-creating flanker. By establishing a coherent dual synergy, Team B forces Team A onto the defensive, compelling picks A_2 and A_3 to address Team B's core threat rather than executing Team A's original strategy.

Double-Pick Window	Primary Tactical Objective	Optimal Composition Pairings	Strategic Pitfall to Avoid
B_1–B_2 Window	Soft-counter A_1 and establish a dominant core synergy.	Heavy Tank + Pocket Sustainer OR Mid Controller + Space-Creating Flanker.	Over-indexing on countering A_1, leaving the comp open to A_2–A_3 counter-picks.
A_2–A_3 Window	Stabilize composition, lock win condition, prevent B_3 punisher.	High-DPS Melter + Self-Peel Anti-Dive Anchor.	Drafting double squishy marksmen with no crowd control, inviting a B_3 dive assassin.

The A_2–A_3 window represents Team A's final draft opportunity, finalizing 100% of its composition and exposing its final lineup to Team B's last pick. Pick A_2 must stabilize any structural deficits in Team A's composition, such as adding high burst damage or wall-break capabilities if A_1 lacked baseline damage. Pick A_3 locks Team A's primary win condition while aggressively addressing the threats established by B_1 and B_2.

The critical principle governing the A_2–A_3 window is the prevention of structural archetype vulnerabilities. If Team A locks two squishy, low-mobility marksmen at A_2 and A_3, Team A creates an ideal environment for an uncounterable B_3 assassin pick. To prevent this draft trap, A_2 or A_3 must integrate self-peel, high effective health, or hard crowd control to retain

defensive capabilities against Team B's final selection.

5. Last Pick (B3) Doctrine

The B_3 selection possesses complete information clarity, viewing all three enemy selections (A_1, A_2, A_3) and both allied selections (B_1, B_2). Consequently, the B_3 slot functions as the ultimate punisher pick in competitive drafting.

The primary rule governing B_3 selection is the execution of a multi-matchup counter calculation. An optimal B_3 pick must achieve a direct hard-counter interaction against at least two enemy brawlers while maintaining a neutral or positive matchup against the third. B_3 must systematically identify and exploit zero-counter vulnerabilities in Team A's composition. If Team A drafted a lineup lacking wall-breakers or high sustained DPS, B_3 must lock a heavy frontline tank or wall-abusing anchor to overwhelm Team A's defenses. If Team A drafted a composition lacking crowd control, knockbacks, or anti-dive tools, B_3 must select a space-creating assassin to collapse Team A's backline.

Competitive drafting principles strictly forbid comfort picking at B_3. Selecting a passive, non-interactive brawler that yields a neutral match state surrenders the game-theoretic advantage inherent in holding last pick. B_3 must function as an aggressive, outcome-deciding selection that forces Team A into an unplayable match dynamic.

6. Mode × Map Frameworks

Drafting frameworks depend on map architecture, including sightline openness, wall chokepoints, and bush density, synthesized with specific game mode objectives.

Mode dynamics dictate foundational draft structures across the rotation. Gem Grab requires a structured three-lane formation featuring a high-survivability Mid Anchor to carry gems alongside two aggressive side-lane flankers. Brawl Ball prioritizes high effective health, wall-breaking capabilities, high-burst anti-tank tools, and knockback crowd control to manage ball possession and goal-line defense. Knockout, Bounty, and Wipeout demand long-range trade efficiency, burst damage, high effective health, and anti-dive tools to secure life-lead advantages. Hot Zone emphasizes persistent area denial, heavy splash damage, and sustained zone occupancy. Heist requires high base-damage output, objective-melting hypercharges, and hard defensive counter-picks to stop base rushes.

Game Mode	Map Archetype	Essential Lane Roles	Primary Brawler Classes	Priority Loadouts & Gears
Gem Grab	Mid-Bush / Chokepoints	Gem Mid + Dual Side Lane Flankers	Area Controllers, Mid Anchors, Pull/CC Specialists	Vision Gear (in grass), Shield Gear, Health Gear
Brawl Ball	Closed / Wall-Heavy	Wall-Breaker + Frontline Tank + Anti-Tank DPS	Heavy Tanks, Burst Anti-Tanks, Knockback Controllers	Speed Gear (in grass), Damage Gear, Health Gear
Knockout	Long Open Lanes	Mid Range Sniper + Scout / Diver + Anti-Dive Support	Long-Range Marksmen, Assassins, Shield Anchors	Shield Gear, Vision Gear, Damage Gear
Hot Zone	Dual / Single Zone	Zone Anchor +	AoE Controllers,	Health Gear,

Game Mode	Map Archetype	Essential Lane Roles	Primary Brawler Classes	Priority Loadouts & Gears
		Splash DPS + Pocket Sustainer	Sustained Healers, Heavy Frontline	Shield Gear, Vision Gear
Heist	Open / Base Corridors	Base Rusher + Anti-Heist Defender + Lane Pusher	Hypercharge Melters, High DPS Sprayers, Anti-Push	Reload Gear, Damage Gear, Gadget Charge

Map architecture directly alters loadout viability and class effectiveness. Open maps favor long-range marksmen and elevate Shield Gear to survive distant trades. Bush-heavy maps increase the value of Vision Gear for scouting and enable short-range tanks equipped with Speed Gear to close distances through cover. Wall-dense maps necessitate wall-breaking capabilities to open sightlines or heavy throwers to dominate trapped enemies behind cover.

7. Counter & Synergy Graph (Practical)

High-ranked drafting requires replacing generic role tags with a functional taxonomy that defines brawlers by their precise tactical mechanics, interaction patterns, and counter relationships. The functional competitive taxonomy classifies brawlers into six distinct operational roles: Mid Anchors and Area Controllers (such as Gene, Berry, and R-T) establish lane control and dictate match pacing through spatial denial; Space-Creating Assassins and Divers (such as Mortis, Kenji, Lily, Kaze, Shade, and Alli) breach backlines, absorb critical cooldowns, and eliminate glass cannons; Anti-Tanks and Tank Melters (such as Colette, Gale, and Clancy) utilize percentage damage and hard crowd control to destroy frontlines; Heavy Frontline Tanks (such as Frank, Sam, Hank, and Bull) leverage massive effective health pools to absorb pressure and secure physical space; Long-Range Marksmen (such as Piper, Nani, and Angelo) dominate open sightlines through high precision burst; and Pocket Sustain Supports (such as Poco, Byron, and Pam) extend allied health pools and maximize tank aggression uptime.

Brawler Role	Superior Matchup Against	Vulnerable Matchup Against	Primary Synergy Partner
Heavy Frontline Tank	Long-Range Marksmen, Low-DPS Anchors.	Anti-Tank Melters, Crowd Control Controllers.	Pocket Sustain Support, Speed Enhancers.
Anti-Tank Melter	Heavy Frontline Tanks, Mid-Range Aggro.	Long-Range Marksmen, Out-Ranging Snipers.	Pull/CC Controllers, Space-Denial Anchors.
Long-Range Marksman	Anti-Tanks, Mid-Range Controllers.	Space-Creating Assassins, Heavy Frontline.	Anti-Dive Anchors, Scouting Controllers.
Space-Creating Assassin	Squishy Marksmen, Low-CC Throwers.	Anti-Dive Anchors, Hard CC Controllers.	High-Burst Finishing Anchors, Mid Area Deniers.

Core interaction triangles dictate draft flow. Heavy Frontline Tanks overwhelm Long-Range Marksmen by advancing through sightlines and absorbing low-clip ammo reserves. Long-Range Marksmen out-range Anti-Tanks and Mid Controllers, shutting them down before they enter threat range. Anti-Tanks destroy Heavy Frontline Tanks using percentage damage and slowing mechanics. Space-Creating Assassins bypass frontline tanks to eliminate squishy backline

marksmen, but are completely hard-countered by Anti-Dive Anchors possessing instant knockbacks, high burst, or emergency shield gadgets.

Direct dual synergies amplify team effectiveness beyond individual stat lines. Pairing Gene with high single-target burst dealers guarantees instant kills whenever Gene pulls an enemy target. Pairing a Heavy Frontline Tank with a Pocket Sustain Support exponentially increases the tank's effective health pool, exhausting opponent ammo reserves. Combining Max's speed buffs with mid-range aggressive brawlers eliminates approach vectors, allowing allies to close gaps instantly. Conversely, direct counters can completely shut down specific picks, such as Colette and Gale neutralizing heavy tanks through percentage damage and knockbacks, or R-T using instant super activation to annihilate diving assassins.

8. Loadout Layer (Gadgets / SP / Gears / HC)

Drafting decisions extend directly into the loadout layer, where selecting optimal Gadgets, Star Powers, Gears, and Hypercharges modifies interaction thresholds, effective health pools, and kill requirements.

Empirical loadout data collected across world championship competition reveals a clear power distribution among available gears. Shield Gear stands as the dominant universal baseline, logged 431 times in world finals play. Shield Gear provides +600 flat extra health with zero conditional triggers or downsides, critically altering survival thresholds across the roster. This additional HP allows squishy marksmen and medium-HP controllers to survive one extra hit from over 30 core brawlers, completely changing match trade dynamics. Damage Gear represents the secondary universal choice, logged 291 times. By granting a +15% damage multiplier when below 50% health, Damage Gear alters damage-per-clip thresholds, enabling clutch turnarounds during low-HP trades.

Vision Gear was logged 71 times, functioning as an essential niche tool on bush-heavy maps or when paired with poison damage-over-time inflictors like Crow, Byron, and Willow to keep enemy positions continuously revealed. Health Gear was selected 65 times, offering high value to tanks and high-HP anchors like R-T, Frank, and Sam. By accelerating health regeneration by 50% while stationary, Health Gear drastically reduces downtime, allowing high-HP anchors to return to lane quickly and maintain continuous pressure. Speed Gear was logged 62 times, restricted primarily to bushy environments for short-range tanks, though it becomes redundant if a brawler's base abilities already override bush speed boosts. Specialized gears—including Reload Speed (26 uses), Mythic Gears (26 uses), Gadget Charge (16 uses), and Super Charge (16 uses)—serve highly specific brawler kits dependent on gadget frequency or super cycle acceleration.

Brawler Archetype	Primary Star Power Rule	Primary Gadget Rule	Priority Gear 1	Priority Gear 2
Long-Range Sniper	Range / Damage Amplification	Instant Knockback / Escape	Shield Gear	Damage Gear
High-HP Frontline Tank	Effective HP Buffer / Speed	Crowd Control / Shield	Health Gear	Damage OR Speed Gear
Mid Anchor Controller	Zone Expansion / Mark Duration	Instant Transformation / CC	Health Gear	Shield OR Gadget Gear
Poison / DOT Dealer	Debuff / Area Control	Slow / Instant Burst	Vision Gear	Shield Gear

Equipping gadgets and star powers must align with specific matchup demands. For example, R-T should utilize the Hacks gadget on open maps against long-range compositions to confirm distant kills, but must switch to the Out of Line gadget when facing aggressive tanks or diving assassins to gain an instant melee super transformation for emergency self-peel. Similarly, Berry utilizes Rapid Growth to maximize zone denial radius in Hot Zone, but switches to Berry Boost and Vine Boost for survival and repositioning in Knockout trades.

9. Ready-Phase Swaps (15s)

The 15-second post-draft ready phase enables teams to trade drafted brawlers among players, decoupling pick sequence priority from individual seat assignments.

In competitive play, individual team members possess varying Power Level 11 account inventories and specialized brawler mastery. Strategic drafting requires securing brawlers based on strict pick priority—such as locking an S-tier power pick at A_1 or a hard counter at B_3—regardless of whether the player drafting in that specific seat plays that brawler. Once all six brawlers are locked, the 15-second swap window allows teammates to trade brawlers so that each player operates their optimal character.

To evaluate and validate ready-phase swaps, software companion tools must execute a multi-step legality and optimization verification chain:

First, the software verifies dual Power Level 11 ownership, confirming that both trading players own both involved brawlers at Power Level 11, as trading an unowned or under-leveled brawler is strictly prohibited by game rules. Second, the system audits complete loadout configurations, ensuring that both players possess fully upgraded Gadgets, Star Powers, Gears, and Hypercharges on their traded brawlers to prevent entering a match with missing equipment. Third, the algorithm executes pilot assignment optimization by evaluating player-specific historical win rates and mastery tiers against the enemy's drafted composition, assigning each brawler to the teammate who achieves the highest calculated win probability.

10. Decision Checklist (Coach Card)

A live companion tool or draft coach must evaluate drafts sequentially through a structured, four-phase heuristic framework:

Phase 1: Pre-Draft Roster & Map Audit

- Audit all three team accounts to verify Power Level 11 legality and establish the shared available brawler pool.
- Analyze map architecture (Open Sightlines, Wall Chokepoints, Bush Density) and confirm game mode objectives.
- Identify team seat position (Team A First Pick versus Team B Last Pick) based on the initial coin flip.

Phase 2: Strategic Ban Execution

- If Team A (First Pick): Ban direct hard counters to the intended A_1 power pick. Avoid banning all tier-zero meta brawlers to preserve first-mover advantage.
- If Team B (Last Pick): Ban unanswerable tier-zero meta brawlers that lack viable

counters, or execute target bans to protect a planned B_3 punisher pick.

Phase 3: Sequential Selection Execution

- Pick A_1: Lock an S-tier Meta Anchor, flexible Midline Controller, or resilient Anti-Tank. Reject short-range assassins, throwers, and squishy glass cannons.
- Pick B_1: Select a soft counter to A_1 or secure a broad lane anchor.
- Pick B_2: Pair directly with B_1 to lock a dominant dual synergy engine (e.g., Tank + Sustainer or Controller + Flanker).
- Pick A_2: Address baseline composition deficits, securing burst damage, wall-break, or range.
- Pick A_3: Lock Team A's primary win condition while incorporating self-peel or anti-dive capabilities to mitigate Team B's last pick.
- Pick B_3: Execute the multi-matchup counter calculation. Lock an uncontested hard counter that exploits zero-counter vulnerabilities in Team A's composition. Reject passive comfort picks.

Phase 4: Loadout & Pilot Swap Audit

- Verify equipment configurations: enforce Shield Gear and Damage Gear baselines, assign Vision Gear on bushy maps, and equip Health Gear on high-HP anchors.
- Select context-specific Gadgets and Star Powers based on enemy range and dive threats.
- Execute ready-phase swaps within the 15-second window to match each drafted brawler to its highest-performing P11 pilot.

11. Data Shape for Software

To power a competitive recommendation engine, data must be structured into JSON schemas representing brawler profiles, live draft states, and post-draft swap legality.

Brawler Profile Schema (brawler_profile.json)

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{
  "brawler_id": "rt_01",
  "name": "R-T",
  "functional_role": "Mid Anchor / Area Controller",
  "power_level_required": 11,

  "stat[span_90] (start_span) [span_90] (end_span) [span_122] (start_span) [span_122] (end_span)_profile": {
    "base_hp": 7600,
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    "range_tier": "Long",
    "dps_burst_tier": "Very High"
  },
}
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    "mode_suitability":
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      "gem_grab": "Mid Anchor",
      "brawl_ball":
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    [span_91] (start_span) [span_91] (end_span) [span_123] (start_span) [span_123] (end_span) "knockout": "Long Range Anchor",
      "hot_zone": "Zone Defender"
    },

    "syn[span_92] (start_span) [span_92] (end_span) [span_124] (start_span) [span_124] (end_span)ergies": ["gene_01", "piper_01", "colette_01"],
      "counters": ["mortis_01", "edgar_01", "mico_01"],
      [span_143] (start_span) [span_143] (end_span) "countered_by":
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      "optimal_loadout": {
        "default_star_power": "Quick Maths",
        "default_gadget": "Hacks",
        "situational_gadget": "Out of Line",
        "primary_gear": "Health Gear",
        "secondary_gear": "Shield Gear"
      }
    }
  }

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Active Draft State Schema (draft_state.json)

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{
  "draft_id": "match_9842",
  "map_id": "shooting_star",
  "mode": "Knockout",
  "coin_flip_winner": "Team_A",

  "cur[span_94] (start_span) [span_94] (end_span) [span_126] (start_span) [span_126] (end_span)rent_turn": "B3",
  "bans": {
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    "team_b": ["piper_01", "kit_01", "meg_01"]
  },
  "picks": [
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    {"seat": "B1", "brawler_id":
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    "p4"},
    {"seat": "B2", "brawler_id": "ash_01", "player_id": "p5"},

```

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    {"seat": "A2", "brawler_id": "colette_01",
"player_i[span_38](start_span)[span_38](end_span)d": "p2"},
    {"seat": "A3", "brawler_id": "brock_01", "player_id": "p3"},
    {"seat": "B3", "brawler_id": null, "player_id": "p6"}
  ],
  "re[span_39](start_span)[span_39](end_span)commendation_output": {
    "target_seat": "B3",
    "top_hard_punishers": [
      {
        "brawler_id": "mortis_01",
        "win_rate_projection": 0.78,
        "rationale": "Team A has zero anti-dive, zero knockback, and
two low-DPS squishy marksmen."
      }
    ]
  }
}

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Roster Swap Matrix Schema (swap_matrix.json)

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{
  "team_id": "trio_alpha",
  "swap_phase_active": true,
  "time_remaining_seconds": 12,
  "roster_legality": {
    "p1": {"p11_brawlers": ["gene_01", "brock_01", "mortis_01"]},
    "p2": {"p11_brawlers": ["colette_01", "gene_01"]},
    "p3": {"p11_brawlers": ["brock_01", "colette_01"]}
  },
  "proposed_swaps": [
    {
      "from_player": "p1",
      "to_player": "p3",
      "trade_brawler_a": "gene_01",
      "trade_brawler_b": "brock_01",
      "legality_status": "VALID_P11_MATCH"
    }
  ]
}

```

12. Anti-Patterns

High-ranked draft failures stem from recognizable structural errors during the ban and pick phases. Software companion logic must actively detect and flag these anti-patterns: The First Pick Assassin Lock occurs when Team A locks a narrow, short-range assassin at A_1.

This selection exposes Team A to immediate hard counters at B_1 and B_2, such as anti-tanks or hard crowd-control anchors, neutralizing A_1 before the draft finishes. The Double-Support Zero-DPS Pitfall happens when a team drafts two passive healers alongside a single mid-range dealer. This composition lacks the sustained damage required to repel heavy frontline tanks or wall-breakers, allowing the enemy team to walk through damage and control physical space. The Loadout and Map Architecture Disconnect occurs when players fail to adapt gears to map features, such as omitting Vision Gear on grass-heavy maps or running Speed Gear on open maps lacking cover. Passive Last Picking occurs when Team B selects a neutral comfort pick at B_3 rather than an aggressive hard counter. Selecting a passive brawler surrenders B_3's information advantage and lowers Team B's statistically higher win rate. Finally, First Pick S-Tier Over-Banning happens when Team A bans all top-tier meta brawlers during the ban phase. Banning all tier-zero options eliminates Team A's first-mover advantage, neutralizing the benefit of winning the initial coin flip.

13. Open Uncertainties

Competitive drafting analysis combines eternal game-theoretic principles with evolving seasonal meta trends. To maintain analytical rigor, software recommendations must explicitly classify confidence levels across distinct knowledge domains:

Draft order game theory and flow dynamics carry high analytical confidence. First-mover mechanics at A_1, information maxima at B_3, and ready-phase swap legality are hard-coded into the game engine. Furthermore, empirical win-rate statistics demonstrating B_3's dominance in mature competitive regions (70% in APAC, 58% in NA) validate the structural value of holding last pick. Loadout hierarchy and gear threshold mechanics also carry high confidence, backed by tournament usage statistics showing Shield Gear (431 uses) and Damage Gear (291 uses) as dominant options.

Specific brawler tier placements carry medium to low confidence over extended timeframes. Individual brawler rankings are volatile, shifting with monthly balance updates, trait reworks, and new Hypercharge releases. Consequently, recommendation software must rely on durable functional role taxonomy and structural interaction models rather than disposable tier lists. Regional playstyle variances carry medium confidence. While APAC demonstrates a strong preference for last-pick counter strategies (70% win rate), South American competitive data shows a higher win rate for first pick (70%). Software algorithms must continuously adapt recommendation weights to reflect regional server trends and current balance patches.

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